C25 Optical Isomerism – Knowledge Organiser: Self-Test

AQA A-level Chemistry • Set 1: Optical Isomerism **Paper 2**

#	Question	Attempt 1	Attempt 2	Attempt 3	Answer
1	Chiral centre				Carbon with four different groups
2	Enantiomers				Non-superimposable mirror images
3	How enantiomers differ				Rotate plane-polarised light in opposite directions
4	Racemic mixture				Equal amounts of each enantiomer
5	Optical activity of a racemic mixture				None (rotations cancel)
6	Planar intermediates that give racemates				Carbocation, C=O group
7	Why a planar intermediate gives a racemate				Equal chance of attack from either side
8	Symbol used to mark a chiral centre				
9	Problem with racemic drugs				One enantiomer may be inactive or harmful
10	Two types of stereoisomerism				E–Z and optical

Fold the Answer column behind the page. Answer each question from memory, then unfold and check. Repeat on a later day in the next Attempt column.